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Trap insects in amber

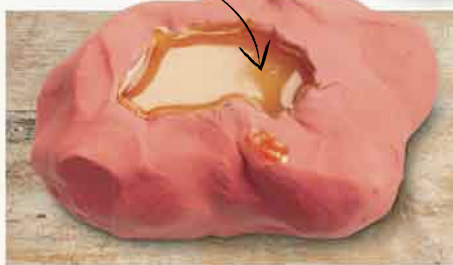
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Amber is the fossilized resin of extinct conifers. It often contains the bodies of ancient insects, trapped there thousands of years ago. You can make your own “amber fossil” of an insect overnight.

Pebble makes a natural shape

What you need

- Dead insects
- Pebble
- Modeling clay
- Clear modeling resin
- Yellow food coloring
- Toothpick
- Petroleum jelly



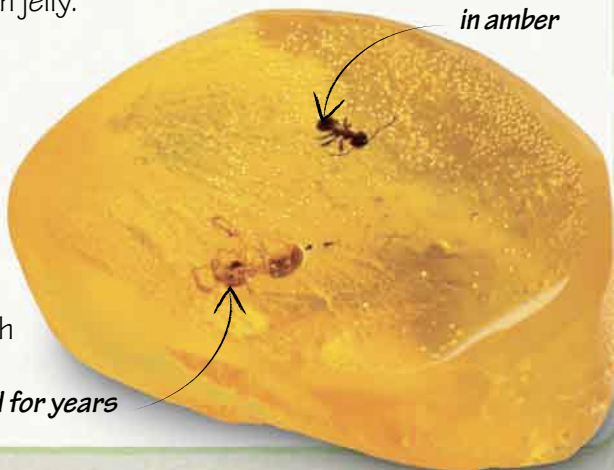
1 Look for dead insects on windowsills indoors or in spider webs outdoors. Press the pebble into the clay. Coat the mold with a little petroleum jelly.

2 Ask an adult to mix the resin—a hardener is usually called for; make sure to follow instructions.

Ants are often found in amber

3 Add a drop of yellow food coloring to the resin, mix well, and pour into the mold. Drop a dead insect on top and push it gently into the resin with the toothpick. When the resin is dry, wash it in soapy water.

The insect will be preserved for years



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Make amber jewelry

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Make your amber fossils into necklaces, pendants, or keyrings. Ask an adult to drill a hole in one end so you can attach a chain. Otherwise, use a jewelry fitting such as a bell cap or bail for a really professional look.

Amber makes a great necklace

